

Millions of games with Maia

What Lichess can tell us about Maia 1, 5, and 9—and what it cannot yet tell us about the people practicing against them.

Official bot accounts only · Public profile totals plus three stale rated-game Insights samples · Collected 2026-10-04T07:12:48+00:00 UTC

6.49 million

distinct games involving the three bots, after removing their head-to-head overlap

59%

of their recorded games were casual, not rated

45,000

rated account-game records in three Insights overview slices

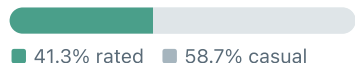
1 · The scale of Maia play

Live profile counters; they keep changing

● **Maia 1** [Lichess profile ↗](#)

3,661,291

all recorded games at collection time

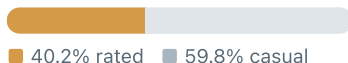


Bot wins 56.9% · draws 6.4% · losses 36.7%

● **Maia 5** [Lichess profile ↗](#)

1,430,845

all recorded games at collection time



Bot wins 55.7% · draws 7.2% · losses 37.1%

● **Maia 9** [Lichess profile ↗](#)

1,394,669

all recorded games at collection time

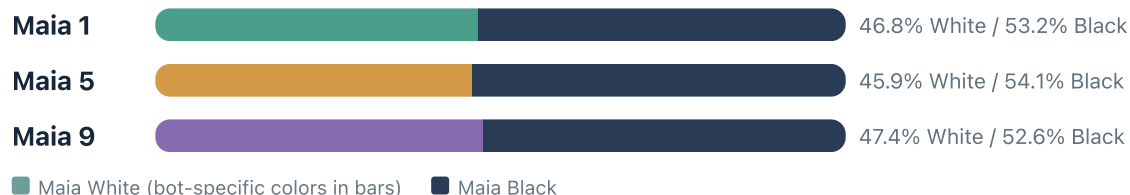


Bot wins 55.7% · draws 7.5% · losses 36.8%

The headline: Maia 1 accounts for 56.4% of bot-account game entries. 3,805,344 entries are casual. Only 21 games were between two of these Maia bots; removing that double-counting leaves 6,486,784 distinct games in this snapshot.

2 · Which side does Maia play?

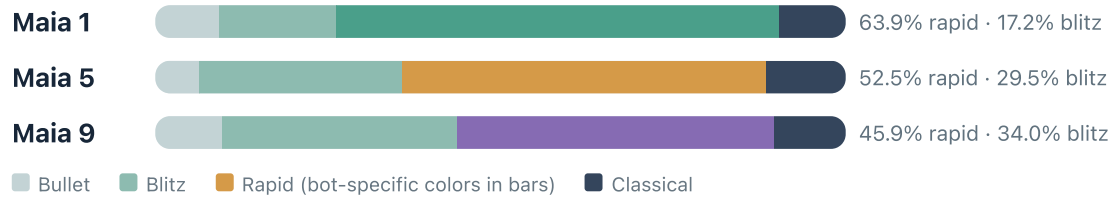
15,000 rated games per bot, not lifetime totals



In each available sample, Maia plays Black slightly more often: about 53–54% of games. This may reflect how challengers choose colors; the data does not establish why.

3 · What kind of games?

Same 15,000-game slices

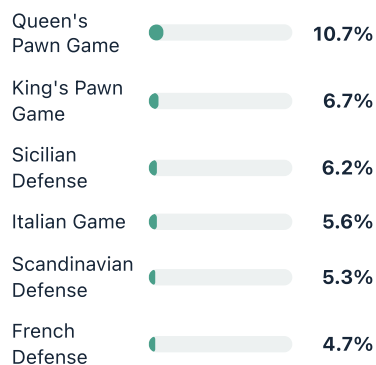


Rapid dominates Maia 1's sample (63.9%), but Maia 9 has a much larger blitz share (34.0%). These samples cover different periods, so do not read this as a controlled comparison of bot strength.

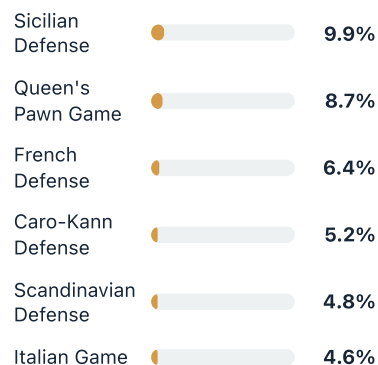
4 · Openings people see against Maia

Top families among 15,000 rated games per bot

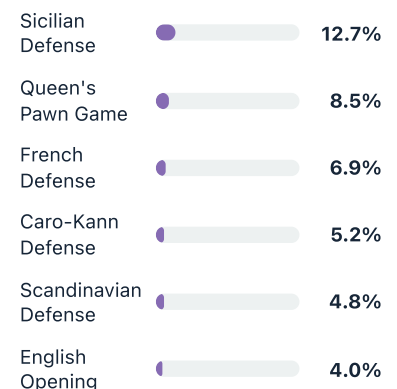
Maia 1



Maia 5



Maia 9



An opening pattern: the Sicilian Defense appears in 6.2% of Maia 1's sample, 9.9% of Maia 5's, and 12.7% of Maia 9's. That is a difference in these samples, not evidence that moving to a harder Maia causes people to change openings.

Opening families describe the resulting position and include moves from both players. These are the top categories returned by Insights, not a complete opening census. Color-filtered queries select a different 15,000-game slice, so they should not be added to these counts.

5 · Your people questions

Answerability is part of the result

NOT MEASURABLE YET

How many unique accounts played Maia?

The public profile counters count games, not distinct opponents. A person can also use multiple accounts. We need game-level opponents for all three bots to count unique Lichess accounts reliably.

NOT MEASURABLE YET

Average games per account?

That is total bot games divided by unique opposing accounts, after de-duplicating games and deciding how to handle bot opponents. The denominator is unavailable from the working endpoints.

NOT MEASURABLE YET

Who plays Maia the most?

No honest lifetime leaderboard is possible from aggregate profiles or Insights. Any names from a small visible page would be a biased sample, not the heaviest users.

NOT ESTABLISHED

Can we see players improving and graduating?

Not without opponent-level games in date order. Even rising win rates could mean repeatable opening tricks or changed time controls. A convincing example would show enough games at each bot level, stronger results over time, and a move to Maia 5 or 9.

How to read this

Three public data sources. Game totals, rated totals, and lifetime bot results come from the three [public profile APIs](#). Pairwise [crosstables](#) identify 21 games between the three bots, which were subtracted once from the sum of profile games. The color, speed, and opening charts come from [Lichess Insights](#) for each account. Insights returned a 15,000-game rated slice for each bot; the indexed collections were marked *stable*. A game between bots could appear in two Insights slices; 45,000 means account-game records, not necessarily unique game IDs.

Not current game samples. The last displayed date-bin labels were Maia 1: 2026-01-24, Maia 5: 2026-01-12, Maia 9: 2026-03-27. These are chart-bin labels, not exact latest-game timestamps. The samples span different periods and are not random lifetime samples. Do not generalize their percentages to all 6,486,805 games.

Why the missing answers? The documented [user-game export](#) initially returned HTTP 404 with a generic User-Agent; that did not establish an outage. A later two-game request with a custom User-Agent returned HTTP 429 ("Please only run 1 request(s) at a time") at 2026-10-04 07:39 UTC. A complete lifetime export has not yet been obtained. The [monthly open database](#) contains rated games only and would exclude most Maia games; reconstructing opponent histories from it would still be incomplete.

Definitions. "Casual" = all profile games minus rated profile games. "Win" means a bot win. "Unique accounts" is not the same as unique people. Official-bot identity was checked against the [Maia Bots team](#) and [Lichess featured-bots listing](#).

Source links: [Maia 1](#) · [Maia 5](#) · [Maia 9](#) · [Maia 1 Insights](#) · [Maia 5 Insights](#) · [Maia 9 Insights](#) · [Lichess open database](#).

Data and reproducible collection code accompany this report. [Read the proposed full-history research plan](#). No opponent usernames were collected or published.